Viet Tran

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EDUCATION

The University of Chicago — Chicago, IL
B.A. candidate · Cognitive Science (intended) — Expected Jun 2029

- Honors: Dean's & Odyssey Scholar (2025), Amazon Future Engineer Scholar (2025), QuestBridge Scholar (2024)

EXPERIENCE

Amazon — Seattle, WA
Incoming Software Development Engineer Intern — Summer 2027

University of Chicago Library — Chicago, IL
Mansueto Circulation Assistant — Sep 2026 – Present

- Operate the Automated Storage and Retrieval (ASR) system to retrieve, return, and audit materials while managing patron services and Scan & Deliver requests

DemystifyAI — Chicago, IL
Product Engineer Intern — Jun 2026 – Sep 2026

- Developed an AI-literacy Chrome extension prototype that brings contextual learning into the AI chat tools people already use, with emphasis on accessibility and user privacy
- Analyzed pre- and post-workshop survey data across 2 AI-literacy workshop sessions, translating user feedback into product and program recommendations for community-facing tools and workshops
- Co-designed AI education programming with the Chicago Housing Authority, incorporating resident feedback into product and workshop development

Bright Bots Initiative — Chicago, IL
UI/UX Design Intern — Jun 2026 – Aug 2026

- Designed and refined learner-facing UI/UX for the Bright Boost web application, improving interface clarity, accessibility, and overall usability
- Collaborated with a small product team to iterate on user flows and interface elements, incorporating feedback into ongoing web app development

University of Chicago — Chicago, IL
Summer Session Residential Assistant — Jun 2026 – Jul 2026

- Supported the residential experience of 90+ high school students per cohort across 2 sessions: move-in/out, daily programming, wake-ups, curfew checks, and student support

PROJECTS

Autonomous Underwater Microplastic Collection via Vortex Formation — ASR Lab · Odessa, WA
Research project — Aug 2024 – Jun 2025

- Engineered an Arduino-based underwater robot with a custom microplastic collection mechanism, iterating on the prototype through testing and design refinement
- Synthesized natural deep eutectic solvents (NaDES) from decanoic acid and menthol to improve microplastic adhesion through hydrophobic interactions
- Ran controlled lab experiments with polyethylene microplastics, comparing solvent-treated and untreated conditions; showed a statistically significant improvement in particle capture ($p < 0.001$)
- 2nd place, Earth & Environmental Sciences, Washington State Science & Engineering Fair (50+ projects); Regional Stockholm Junior Water Prize; NOAA "Taking the Pulse of the Planet" award

RF System Embedded in Search Robots to Increase Rescue Range — ASR Lab · Odessa, WA
Research project — Aug 2022 – Jul 2023

- Engineered an Arduino-based search-and-rescue robot with RF sensing and communication, testing detection range and reliability across simulated debris-obstruction scenarios

LEADERSHIP & INVOLVEMENT

Future Business Leaders of America (FBLA) — Odessa, WA
Chapter President — Jun 2024 – Jun 2025

- Led a $68,000+ renovation of the Old Town Hall building: new windows, flooring, plumbing, bathroom, and electrical system
- Top 10 at the FBLA National Leadership Conference (2025); 3 Washington FBLA State Champion titles (2023–2025)

SKILLS

Languages: Python, Java, C/C++, HTML/CSS
Tools: Git, VS Code, Arduino, Android Studio, MATLAB
Design: UI/UX, user research, prototyping, survey analysis
Certifications: Microsoft Office Specialist: Excel, Access, PowerPoint, Word
Spoken: Vietnamese and English (bilingual)